

Speculative Design Workshop

Building Bridges between Technology, Ethics, and Social Inclusion

Informed Consent Form (ICF)

Dear participant,

On October 7th, 2024, you took part in the Short Course *Speculative Design – Building Bridges between Technology, Ethics, and Social Inclusion*, a 6-hour activity conducted by researchers Marcelo Soares Loutfi, Beatriz Ventorini Lins de Albuquerque, Charles Siqueira Xavier, and Sean Wolfgang Matsui Siqueira. This short course is part of Marcelo Loutfi's doctoral research conducted in the PPGI – UNIRIO, and your perceptions about the event are of great importance to us.

We would like to invite you to answer the questionnaire below, which will help us understand your impressions of the short course. Your responses will contribute to the evaluation of the event's results and to identifying opportunities for improvement. We emphasize that the questionnaire is anonymous, and all collected data will be used exclusively for academic and scientific purposes within the context of this research.

We thank you in advance for your participation and valuable contribution.

Sincerely,

Marcelo Loutfi

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Participant Profile

Indicate your level of knowledge and previous experience with Speculative Design.

5 responses

- **80%** — I did not know about it and have never applied it.
- **20%** — I already knew about it, but have never applied it.
- **0%** — I have applied it a few times.
- **0%** — I have applied it many times.
- **0%** — I have extensive knowledge and experience in the subject.

Indicate your main area of study and/or work

5 responses

- **60%** — Education and Training

- **20%** — Software Development
- **20%** — Other
- **0%** — Requirements Analysis
- **0%** — Business Intelligence (BI)
- **0%** — Project Management
- **0%** — Information Security
- **0%** — Database Administration
- **0%** — User Experience (UX) and User Interface (UI)

Indicate the group you belonged to during the workshop

5 responses

- **20%** — G1
- **40%** — G2
- **20%** — G3
- **0%** — G4
- **20%** — I don't remember

Attention Dimension

What captured your attention the most during the workshop, and why?

This question aims to identify which elements or activities were most engaging, helping to highlight the most impactful aspects of the workshop.

5 responses

1. *I really enjoyed the activity in which we had to envision disruptive technologies and create a story to contextualize the use of the technology for the other groups.*
2. *Watching a design solution being gradually developed from the contribution of each activity carried out. The materials used in the exercises—such as large colorful sheets and post-its—also contributed to my engagement with the content.*
3. *1 — The moments when we classified the implications as desirable/positive/negative and high/medium/low magnitude, because of the different (geometric) shapes used to make this classification.*

2 — The Technological Mediation Cards, because they stimulated creativity in imagining different solutions for the proposed scenarios.
4. *I believe that seeing Speculative Design in practice as a method for exploring possible futures and questioning the ethical and social impacts of technologies was what stood out to me the most.*
5. *I really liked the cards; I found them very creative.*

Was there any moment during the workshop that was particularly surprising or unexpected?

Describe how this influenced your learning experience.

5 responses

1. *The best — and most surprising — moment was the final session, when we had access to the stories and technologies presented by the other groups.*
2. *The brainstorming activity using the Technological Mediation Cards was an unexpected exercise and proved to be surprisingly practical in supporting the developed solutions. Pushing beyond the limits of current technological capabilities and imagining unusual scenarios within the context of the problem was not only fun but also highly enriching.*
3. *I think the presentation stage. At that moment, we had to review all the progress of our idea, and it helped us compile everything we learned and produced during the workshop.*
4. *The discussions on social inclusion and ethics had a strong impact on me... It was interesting to interact with the participants and reflect on these issues.*
5. *I enjoyed the part where we could create the most unimaginable scenarios about the future.*

Relevance Dimension

How do you relate the concepts learned in the workshop to your professional or academic activities?

5 responses

1. *Perhaps a direct relationship with the need that a professor/researcher has to innovate in their professional activities.*
2. *The concepts learned expand the knowledge base necessary for software development activities. They help in considering the current scenario of a given application, identifying relationships and stakeholders, and contributing to a comprehensive analysis that supports the development of creative and context-appropriate solutions.*
3. *It is relevant to my field because I work with interface development (prototyping) in my research group.*
4. *The approach can enhance my ability to anticipate challenges and create projects that are more aligned with human needs and with the impacts that may arise in the medium and long term.*
5. *Collaborative work, collective thinking...*

In what way did the workshop address issues that are important to you in your field of work?

5 responses

1. *I believe that our group tries to incorporate aspects of diversity and inclusion into the solutions we envision, and although this topic was not the main focus of the workshop, the way the activities were conducted allowed us to explore it.*
2. *By presenting strategies for conceiving innovative ideas while considering market trends.*
3. *By making us stop to think about the implications—both positive and negative—of the products we develop.*
4. *I believe that speculative design challenging conventional assumptions and exploring alternative futures was a very important aspect for me. The provocative scenarios developed during the workshop and the narratives were interesting in helping us reflect on our own practices.*
5. *When imagining scenarios, these scenarios can be of any nature; therefore, the approach is viable in any field of work.*

Confidence Dimension

What skills or knowledge acquired during the workshop do you feel confident applying? And which ones do you feel you need more support with?

5 responses

1. *I believe I need more rounds of the workshop to feel confident applying the proposed speculative design technique. There are many steps.*
2. *I feel confident sharing the general idea of the Speculative Design framework presented, especially the sections on analyzing the current scenario, identifying the involved agents and their relationships, observing trends, and recognizing implications. The areas where I would need more support are sociotechnical analysis and the consolidation of the obtained results to conceive a concrete solution based on the defined timeframe.*
3. *I feel confident applying the concept of involved agents and the implications of trends (including their classification).*
4. *I believe I need more support to identify the trends themselves and to explore the Technological Mediation Cards without drifting too far from the initial project.*
5. *I feel confident applying the techniques for constructing speculative scenarios, bringing them into practice to imagine alternative futures and explore the ethical and social implications of technologies. But I still need to delve deeper into applying speculative design frameworks in real and complex contexts... this was my first “interaction” with Speculative Design.*

After participating in the workshop, how do you assess your ability to contribute to discussions or projects involving speculative design?

5 responses

1. *I believe it broadened my mind regarding the possibility of imagining new technologies. I think that in a master's program, a PhD, and scientific research in general, we are often required to stay very grounded.*
2. *I believe I now have enough knowledge to understand the foundations of discussions or projects and contribute with ideas based on the concepts learned throughout the workshop.*
3. *I believe I now have enough knowledge to understand discussions involving the topic, and it can especially help me incorporate speculative design into my own projects.*
4. *I recognize that I still need more experience... learning more about the subject and how to apply it in real projects.*
5. *Moderate. I still have a lot to learn, but I would love to participate in more speculative design workshops.*

Satisfaction Dimension

What did you value the most in the workshop, and what do you think could be improved to increase participant satisfaction?

5 responses

1. *The group interaction was the highlight of the workshop. Regarding improvements, I think there could have been more time to carry out the activities. It was very rushed.*
2. *I really appreciated the practical moments, all directly related to the content presented. One thing that could be improved is the amount of time dedicated to each activity, which turned out to be short on some occasions.*
3. *What I valued most were the tools presented, such as the model for building the ecosystem, the charts for classifying implications, and the technological mediation cards.*
4. *What could be improved is perhaps explaining more clearly at the beginning of each step how it connects to the previous one. I felt I had some difficulty with this during the presentation.*
5. *I loved the practical and reflective approach — the dynamic encouraged interaction among participants, creativity, and critical thinking. I would have liked to see practical examples of applying speculative design in different contexts, such as real projects in companies or organizations (although I know time was limited). I think everything went very well.*

Would you recommend this workshop to a colleague or friend? Please explain your answer, including what would make you more or less inclined to recommend it.

5 responses

1. *Yes. I found it important for helping us think outside the box, but in a structured way.*
2. *Yes, I would recommend the workshop to a friend interested in the HCI field. The reproduction of the activities with a little more time would make me even more inclined to recommend it, unlike a purely theoretical approach, which would make me less inclined.*
3. *Yes, I would recommend it mainly to friends who study or work in the design field.*
4. *Yes, I would recommend it! I like the creative and reflective approach on the ethical and social impact of technologies. The practical dynamics made learning engaging and applicable, especially for those working with innovation. It was an enriching and inspiring experience.*
5. *Yes. In the healthcare field, it is necessary to think about ways to serve a very diverse audience with information and services. My friends in health research would enjoy this approach to imagining new ways of doing their work.*